

traffic manager and the locomotive superintendent to take care of the working of trains, traffic, locomotives, other rolling stock, as well as stations, and tickets. It was now separated into the Traffic Department under the general manager and the Locomotive Department under the locomotive superintendent.

Governmental restructuring

Meanwhile, with the growth of the railways and other development projects in India, the Central Public Works Department was undergoing changes as well. A separate railway branch under a special deputy secretary was created in 1866. A consulting engineer for guaranteed companies was also appointed. Even when the railway lines of a company passed through multiple provinces, these were managed by one consulting engineer. Over the course of time, with rigorous construction and expansion, regional consulting engineers, with expert knowledge specific to provinces, were appointed to work with the local government. Routine work was to be taken care of by the provincial consulting engineers while matters of strategic importance were to be handled by the Government.

Random policies

There was hardly any legislation pertaining to railways passed during this time. The first provision came about in 1854, one year after the first passenger train ran in India, and its scope was limited to regulations, including fares, tickets, illegal activities, fencing, and the liability of railways with regard to traffic. Overall, the Act lacked substance and failed to provide any real legal safety and provisions to the public, especially with regard to working conditions and discrimination. Following this, an Act passed in 1865 primarily dealt with the liabilities of railways and tramways in case of any loss or injury, and not just those brought on by negligence or misconduct of their workers. Two more acts were passed in 1870 and 1871 to deal with accidents and cattle trespasses.

This motley collection of legislation failed to provide a solid railway policy and was ineffective in the long run. It would not be until the